GUIDE 01 TEN JOBS · WHAT EACH COSTS · WHAT EACH SAVES

The owner's guide to AI that earns its keep.

Ten jobs AI should already be doing in an established business. What each one costs you now, what fitted looks like, how long it takes, and the five questions that tell a fitting from a demo. Written for owners, not for IT.

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AI, FITTED · LONDON

Most firms your size have adopted AI. Almost none have installed it.

Over half of UK SMEs now say they use AI. The British Chambers of Commerce, surveying 668 firms with Atos in early 2026, put it at 54%, up from 35% a year before. A separate survey of 1,320 small firms by Enterprise Nation and Strand Partners in May 2026 found that 6% have AI embedded in day-to-day work.

Those two numbers describe the same businesses. One in two has a subscription. One in twenty has changed how the work gets done. The rest have a seat someone pays for, a prompt found on LinkedIn and used twice, a pilot that stalled in March, and an owner who is still re-keying numbers on a Sunday.

The difference is not the tool. Every business in the survey has access to the same models. The difference is the fitting: whether the AI lives inside the systems the business already runs, reads what it needs to read, writes where it needs to write, follows instructions somebody actually wrote down, and flags the things it is not sure about to a human.

That is a trade, not a subscription. It is the difference between buying a boiler and having it plumbed in.

54% adopted

UK SMEs saying they use AI. BCC with Atos, 668 UK businesses, Jan to Feb 2026 (35% in 2025).

6% installed

Small firms with AI embedded in daily work. Enterprise Nation with Strand Partners, 1,320 UK SMEs, May 2026.

What is in this guide

02 The ten jobs, one page each pair, with what each costs you now and what fitted looks like

03 Payback order: where to start and why

04 Five questions that tell a fitting from a demo

05 What a written way of working is, and why it is the whole job

06 How a fitting goes: Ledgerwright, step by step

07 The scorecard, to fill in with a pen

08 What to do next

Ten jobs AI should already be doing.

Each job shows up the same way: a few hours a week that a capable person, usually the owner or the best person in the office, spends doing something a machine could do. For each: how it shows up, what it costs now, what fitted looks like, what it needs.

01 · Bank reconciliation

HOW IT SHOWS UP	Month end takes days, not hours. Someone matches bank lines to invoices and bills by hand. The owner finds out the real cash position a week late.
WHAT IT COSTS NOW	Xero's own survey of small businesses found owners spend an average of 15.5 hours a month importing and reconciling bank statements, and three in ten spend 20 to 40. If a bookkeeper does it instead, it is their hours and your wait.
FITTED	An agent reconciles the bank feed every morning, codes recurring spend to rules you set once, and leaves the handful it is unsure about for a human, with the reason. Month end is a check, not a job.
NEEDS	XERO · WRITTEN RULES · 30 DAYS TO FIT

02 · Chasing invoices

HOW IT SHOWS UP	Chasing is somebody's job, done when they remember. Debtors sit at 50 days. The awkward phone calls get left.
WHAT IT COSTS NOW	A person's afternoon a week, and the cash sitting in other people's bank accounts. Count your debtor days against your terms; the gap is the cost.
FITTED	A credit-control agent sends reminders on your schedule and in your tone, escalates politely, and gives you a short list each week of the ones only a phone call will fix.
NEEDS	XERO · EMAIL · 2 TO 3 WEEKS

03 · Quotes and proposals

HOW IT SHOWS UP	Every quote starts from a blank page or the last one someone can find. They go out slowly, inconsistently, and the margin depends on who wrote it.
WHAT IT COSTS NOW	Hours per quote, slower replies than your competitor, and quotes won at the wrong margin because the pricing logic lives in one head.
FITTED	A drafter reads the enquiry, pulls the last fifty quotes you won, and drafts the next one in your words with your margins. A person checks it and sends it the same day.
NEEDS	EMAIL · YOUR PRICE LIST · 3 TO 4 WEEKS

04 · The shared inbox

HOW IT SHOWS UP	Requests arrive in info@ or sales@ and stay there. Nobody owns them. A customer chases, and that is how you learn a job was dropped.
WHAT IT COSTS NOW	Lost orders you never see, and the hour a day someone spends triaging an inbox that should triage itself.
FITTED	An inbox agent turns each request into a task with an owner and a date, replies to the easy ones in your tone, and chases the ones that stall.
NEEDS	OUTLOOK OR GMAIL · YOUR TASK BOARD · 2 TO 3 WEEKS

05 · Re-keying between systems

HOW IT SHOWS UP	An order lands in one system and someone types it into another. A spreadsheet is the bridge between your CRM and Xero. The same name is spelled three ways.
WHAT IT COSTS NOW	Hours a week, errors that surface at month end, and a person who cannot take a holiday because the bridge is them.
FITTED	A connector moves the data once, checks it, and flags anything that does not match. The spreadsheet retires.
NEEDS	BOTH SYSTEMS · MATCHING RULES · 2 TO 4 WEEKS

06 · The management pack

HOW IT SHOWS UP	The monthly numbers are built by hand in a spreadsheet, late, and nobody writes the paragraph that explains them. The board meeting is spent explaining the table.
WHAT IT COSTS NOW	A day or two of the best person's month, and decisions taken on figures three weeks old.
FITTED	The pack pulls itself from Xero and your sheets on the first working day, lays the numbers out the same way every month, and writes the commentary a good finance director would.
NEEDS	XERO · SHEETS · 3 WEEKS

07 · The Monday exceptions report

SHOWS UP	You hear about problems from customers, not from a report. Late jobs, unpaid invoices and unhappy replies surface one at a time, by phone.
FITTED	Monday at seven, a one-page report: what went wrong last week and what will go wrong this week if nobody acts. You read it with your coffee.
NEEDS	XERO · CRM · 2 WEEKS

08 · Questions that have an answer somewhere

SHOWS UP	Staff ask the same questions. Customers ask the same questions. The answers exist, in a document, an email thread or the owner's head.
FITTED	Your written way of working, loaded into Claude, so your team and your customers get the answer your best person would give, with a human for the rest.
NEEDS	CLAUDE · YOUR DOCUMENTS · 2 TO 4 WEEKS

09 · Supplier bills and approvals

SHOWS UP	Bills arrive by email, get printed, approved by hand and coded by guesswork. Duplicates get paid. The approver is on holiday.
FITTED	Bills are read, coded to your rules, checked for duplicates and routed to the right approver with a one-line summary. The approver taps once.
NEEDS	XERO · EMAIL · 2 TO 3 WEEKS

10 · Onboarding and training

SHOWS UP	A new starter takes three months to be useful because how things are done lives in people, not on paper. The owner trains everyone personally.
FITTED	The written way of working becomes the training. A new starter asks it questions on day one and gets your answers, not the internet's.
NEEDS	CLAUDE · A WRITTEN WAY OF WORKING · FOLLOWS JOB 08

A note on the hours. The 15.5-hour figure for reconciliation is Xero's, from its own survey of small businesses. The rest we have described rather than invented, because every business is different and a number pulled from the air is a number you cannot trust. The audit puts your own numbers on each job, and that is the only version worth acting on.

Where to start, and why it is usually the boring one.

Owners want to start with the exciting job: the quote drafter, the thing customers will see. Start with the boring one. Three reasons.

It pays back fastest. Reconciliation and credit control are high-volume, rule-based and already inside a system you run. The hours are real and they recur every month. A quote drafter is worth more per quote but the volume is lower and the rules are fuzzier.

It proves the plumbing. The first job teaches you, and us, how your data actually looks: the duplicate contacts, the rules nobody wrote down, the bank feed that lags a day. Better to learn that on the ledger than in front of a customer.

It builds the written way of working. Every fitting adds a page to the document that describes how your business really runs. By the fourth job, most of the instructions are already written.

A worked example, with the assumptions shown

Take reconciliation at Xero's average of 15.5 hours a month. If a bookkeeper at £30 an hour does it, that is £465 a month, or £5,580 a year, before you count the owner's own hours at month end or the cost of finding out the cash position late. A fixed-price agent at £4,999 pays back inside the first year on the bookkeeper's hours alone, and in a few months if the owner's hours are counted at what the owner's hours are actually worth.

Change the rate and the hours to your own and the sum changes. That is the point: do your sum, not ours.

ORDER	JOB	WHY HERE
1	Bank reconciliation	Daily volume, clear rules, one system, measurable hours
2	Chasing invoices	Cash arrives sooner; the agent reuses the same Xero fitting
3	Supplier bills and approvals	Same system again; removes duplicate payments
4	Re-keying between systems	Removes the spreadsheet bridge and the person trapped behind it
5	The management pack	Only works once jobs 1 to 4 have cleaned the data
6	The Monday exceptions report	Cheap once the pack exists; it reads the same data
7	The shared inbox	High value, but needs your tone and your rules written first
8	Questions with an answer somewhere	The written way of working is now mostly written
9	Quotes and proposals	Highest value per use; needs the most judgement and the best instructions
10	Onboarding and training	Falls out of job 8 almost for free

A typical order, not a rule. A business whose cash problem is debtors starts at 2. One whose owner is the only person who knows anything starts at 8.

How to tell a fitting from a demo.

Anyone who says they "do AI" should be able to answer these five in plain English, in a meeting, without a slide. If they cannot, you are being shown a demo. Demos are free and they are worth what you pay for them.

01 **Which of our systems will it live inside, and what will it read and write?**

A fitting names the systems: Xero, Outlook, your CRM, the sheet on the shared drive. A demo talks about "integration" in general. If the answer is "it sits alongside", it will sit alongside, unused, within a month.

02 **What happens when it is not sure?**

The right answer is that it stops and asks a named person, with the reason. The wrong answer is that it is very accurate. Everything is very accurate until the one bank line that is not, and that line is the one that matters.

03 **Who writes the instructions, and where do they live afterwards?**

The instructions are the product. They should be written in plain English, in a document you own and can read, and they should describe how your business actually works. If the instructions live in someone else's system, so does your business.

04 **What does it cost, fixed, and what does support look like after it is live?**

A fixed price and a defined support period mean the risk is theirs. A day rate and a "let's see how it goes" mean the risk is yours. Ask for the number before you ask for the demo.

05 **Show me it running on last month's real data.**

Not a sample. Not a slide. Your bank feed, your invoices, last month. If it cannot run on what you already have, it is not fitted and it is not ready.

The document that is the whole job.

Every business your size runs on knowledge that is not written down. How you price a rush job. Which customers get thirty days and which get seven. What a "normal" week's spend looks like at the fuel card. Who approves what. What you say when a customer is angry, and what you never say.

That knowledge is why the business works and also why it cannot grow without you. It is in the heads of three people, one of whom is you.

A written way of working is that knowledge, on paper, in plain English, in the order someone would need it. Not a procedures manual nobody reads. A short, specific, honest description of how the work gets done here, with the exceptions included.

It matters for AI because an agent is only as good as its instructions. Load it with your written way of working and it answers like your best person. Load it with nothing and it answers like the internet. Every fitted job we do starts with this document, adds to it, and leaves it with you.

It matters without AI too. It is the document that lets you take a holiday, hire someone good, and one day sell the business for what it is worth rather than for what it is worth without you.

What goes in it

01 **Who we are for, and who we are not for.** The customers you want and the ones you turn away.

02 **How we price.** Margins, rush rules, discounts, who can approve a deviation.

03 **How we answer.** Tone, speed, the phrases we use, the ones we never use.

04 **How money moves.** Terms, chasing, approvals, what gets paid without asking.

05 **How work moves.** From enquiry to invoice, who owns each step, where it gets stuck.

06 **What normal looks like.** The numbers that mean the week went well, and the ones that mean ring the owner.

07 **The exceptions.** The customers, suppliers and situations that break the rules, and what to do instead.

Most businesses can write a first version in a day with someone asking the right questions. That day is the most valuable day of the audit.

Ledgerwright, step by step.

Ledgerwright is our reconciliation agent for Xero. It began as the agent built to take reconciliation off a real finance desk, and it is the first tool we sell at a fixed price. Here is how a fitting goes, including the parts that go wrong.

01 **Week one: the rules.** We sit with whoever does the books and write down how they reconcile: which suppliers are what, which payments are transfers, what counts as a rule and what needs a human. Most of these rules have never been written anywhere. This is where half the value is.

02 **Week two: the fitting.** Ledgerwright is installed into your own Claude with those instructions and connected to Xero. It reads the bank feed and your invoices and bills. It writes nothing yet.

03 **Week three: the parallel run.** It reconciles last month alongside the person who did it for real. Every difference is examined. Usually the agent is right about the routine lines and the human is right about the odd ones, and the rules get sharper.

04 **Week four: live.** It runs every morning. The handful of lines it is unsure about wait in a list with the reason. Someone clears them in ten minutes over a coffee.

05 **Ninety days: keep.** We stay on. New suppliers appear, a bank changes how it labels something, the business opens a second account. The rules grow with it.

What goes wrong, and what we do about it

Duplicate contacts. The same supplier exists three times in Xero. The agent matches to the wrong one. Fix: merge them in week one, which the business should have done years ago.

Rules that were never rules. "We always code that to marketing" turns out to mean "except in December". The parallel run finds it. The written rule gets an exception.

Lagging feeds. One bank's feed arrives a day late. The agent learns to wait for it rather than flag everything as unmatched at seven in the morning.

The human stops checking. The most common failure. Fix: the unsure list is short, specific and in someone's name, and we look at it with you for the first ninety days.

£4,999

One payment. Installed into your Claude, your written instructions, ninety days of support. Installed and reconciling within thirty days, or we keep working with you until it is, at no extra charge.

Which jobs should AI already be doing for you?

Eight statements. Tick the ones that are true of your business this month. Each one you tick is a job on the right. Three to five ticks is where most established businesses sit. Six or more and the business is carrying work an agent could be doing before anyone is in.

☐	Month end takes more than two days.	LEDGERWRIGHT: XERO RECONCILED EVERY MORNING
☐	Someone re-keys data between two systems every week.	A FITTED CONNECTOR BETWEEN THE TWO SYSTEMS
☐	Jobs go into the inbox and get forgotten.	AN INBOX AGENT THAT TURNS EMAILS INTO TASKS WITH OWNERS
☐	Quotes or proposals are written from scratch each time.	A QUOTE DRAFTER WORKING FROM THE LAST FIFTY YOU WON
☐	You hear about problems from customers, not from a report.	A WEEKLY EXCEPTIONS REPORT, BEFORE THE CUSTOMER CALLS
☐	Management reports are built by hand in a spreadsheet.	A MANAGEMENT PACK THAT WRITES ITSELF
☐	Chasing invoices is somebody's job.	A CREDIT-CONTROL AGENT THAT CHASES, POLITELY, ON SCHEDULE
☐	Only the owner knows how it all fits together.	YOUR WRITTEN WAY OF WORKING, LOADED INTO CLAUDE

0 TO 2 TIGHTER THAN MOST

You are already running a disciplined shop. The audit would still find hours, but you are not bleeding them.

3 TO 5 HOURS ON THE TABLE

Where most businesses your size sit. Each tick is a job that can be fitted. The audit puts a number and a fixed price on each.

6 TO 8 THIS IS WHERE THE MONEY IS

The business is carrying work a fitted agent could be doing before anyone is in. Start with the boring one.

Tell us where the hours go.

The audit is free. We sit with you and your team for about four hours over two weeks, map where the hours go across finance, operations, sales and admin, and write it up: ten jobs, ranked by payback, each with a fixed price to fit. You keep the report whether or not you work with us.

If we cannot find at least ten hours a month worth saving, we tell you, and the report is still yours.

We take on twenty audits a month and twenty Ledgerwright installs, because we do them properly.

01 **Apply.** Two minutes at gainwright.ai.

02 **A call.** Twenty minutes, within three working days, to check it is a fit.

03 **Two weeks.** About four hours of your time across them.

04 **The report.** Ten jobs, payback order, a fixed price for each. Yours to keep.

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